

Meaningful Motion Report

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Site Details

My live motion page is at <https://pwoolls1.github.io/WDD331R/unit-6/motion/index.html> and the source code is at <https://pwoolls1.github.io/WDD331R/>.

Reflection

Write a thoughtful response to each prompt. These are not summaries of what you did. They ask you to reason about why your motion choices work the way they do and what would change if you had made different decisions.

Transitions and Easing

For my cards, I chose to transition transform, box-shadow, and border-color because those properties clearly communicate interactivity without changing the actual layout of the page. The card lifts slightly on hover, the shadow becomes stronger, and the border gains emphasis, which makes the card feel clickable without overpowering the content inside it.

I used a custom easing curve that feels quick at the beginning and softer at the end. This makes the card feel responsive when the user hovers over it, but not harsh or mechanical. I also used a faster hover-in duration and a slightly slower return timing, which makes the interaction feel more natural, like the card quickly reacts to attention and then settles back into place.

If I had used linear, the motion would feel too robotic because the card would move at the same speed the entire time. If I had used transition: all, the browser might animate properties I did not intend to animate, which could create awkward effects, performance issues, or unpredictable motion.

Keyframe Animation

The status badge animation communicates that the dashboard is live and active. The subtle pulse suggests that the system is running without making the badge feel like a distracting decoration. I avoided spinning or flashing because those effects would draw too much attention and would not match the calm “all systems operational” message.

Using animation-direction: alternate matters because it lets the animation move smoothly back and forth instead of snapping back to the starting state at the end of each loop. I also used compositor-friendly properties like transform and opacity because an infinite animation runs for as long as the page is open. These properties are better choices because they can animate smoothly without forcing the browser to constantly recalculate layout.

Reduced Motion

I used the prefers-reduced-motion: no-preference containment approach. That means the main transitions and animations only run when the user has not asked for reduced motion. I chose this because it keeps motion as an enhancement instead of the default experience.

When reduced motion is active, the status badge no longer continuously pulses. Instead, it keeps a static visual treatment, such as an outline, so it still looks intentionally active without constant movement. I verified this in Chrome DevTools by opening the Rendering panel and changing the prefers-reduced-motion emulation to reduce. When that was active, the hover transitions and card entrance animations stopped, and the badge changed to the reduced-motion version.